

Parallel Six

Master the Art of the Pivot

Persistence is staying committed to the goal. Discipline is knowing when changing the approach is what's required to achieve the goal.

Leadership Model: PIVOT

Put It into Play

Reflection Questions

Make time to reflect before you lead forward.

1. What new signals are customers, employees, or the market giving me?

2. What evidence challenges our current approach or suggests our assumptions have changed?

3. Am I staying committed to the goal while remaining open to changing the approach?

Team Conversation Prompts

Use these questions to spark meaningful conversations with your team.

1. What is changing around us, and what emerging risks or opportunities deserve attention?

2. What if our assumptions are wrong, and what other approaches could achieve our goal?

3. Have we preserved enough options and developed contingency plans?

4. Is it time to pivot, what should remain constant, and how will we communicate the change?

Manager Conversation Prompts

Use these questions during your next one-on-one or performance discussion.

1. Where might I be ignoring evidence because I want the original plan to succeed?

2. What alternatives or contingency plans should I develop before they become necessary?

3. What evidence would give you confidence that a change in approach is warranted?

Take Action

Which one or two of these actions would benefit my team and our performance most?

1. I will monitor changing signals and identify one emerging risk or opportunity.

2. I will challenge a current assumption and develop alternative ways to achieve the goal.

3. I will seek evidence that both supports and challenges our current approach.

4. I will preserve alternatives and build a contingency plan where we risk becoming locked in.

5. I will act when the evidence supports a pivot and explain what is changing and what remains constant.

